

Crime in India – 2023

SNAPSHOTS

(Metropolitan Cities - >2 Million Population)

(19 Metropolitan Cities : Ahmedabad, Bengaluru, Chennai, Coimbatore, Delhi, Ghaziabad, Hyderabad, Indore, Jaipur, Kanpur, Kochi, Kolkata, Kozhikode, Lucknow, Mumbai, Nagpur, Patna, Pune and Surat)

A) Overall Crime

A total of 9,44,291 cognizable crimes comprising 6,67,351 Indian Penal Code (IPC) crimes and 2,76,940 Special & Local Laws (SLL) crimes were registered in 19 metropolitan cities during 2023, showing an increase of 10.6% over 2022 (8,53,470 cases). [Table – 1B.1& 1B.2]

During 2023, IPC crimes registered have increased by 7.6% and SLL crimes registered have increased by 18.8% over 2022. [Table – 1B.1& 1B.2]

Percentage share of IPC was 70.7% while percentage share of SLL cases was 29.3% during 2023. [Table – 1B.1& 1B.2]

Under IPC crimes, majority of cases were registered under Theft accounting for 44.8% (2,99,203 out of 6,67,351 cases) followed by Rash Driving on Public way 9.2% (61,570 cases) and Obstruction on Public way (Sec 283 IPC) with 8.1% (53,742 cases) during 2023. [Table – 1B.4]

Under SLL crimes, majority of cases were registered under Prohibition Act accounting for 26.7% (74,077 out of 2,76,940 cases) followed by Motor Vehicle Act accounting for 12.5% (34,656 cases) and Narcotic Drugs & Psychotropic Substances Act accounting for 10.3% (28,642 cases) during 2023. [Table – 1B.5]

During 2023, total of 10,35,993 IPC cases (3,68,572 cases pending from previous year + 6,67,351 cases reported during the year + 70 cases re-opened for investigation) were under investigation, out of which total of 6,84,933 cases were disposed of by police including 3,53,861 cases which were charge sheeted, resulting in the charge sheeting rate of 51.7%. [Table-17B.1]

B) Offences Affecting the Human Body¹ - Summary

A total of 92,610 cases of offences affecting the human body were registered which accounted for 13.9% of total IPC crimes in 19 metropolitan cities during 2023. Out of these cases Hurt (44,954 cases) accounted for maximum cases i.e. 48.5% followed by cases of Kidnapping & Abduction (15,039 cases, 16.2%) and Causing Death by Negligence (9,968 cases, 10.8%). [Table – 1B.4]

The cases registered under offences against human body depict an increase of 6.5% in 2023 over 2022 (86,951 cases). The crime rate registered under this head shows an increase from 76.2 in 2022 to 81.2 in 2023. [Table – 1B.4]

Note: 1: Chapter XVI of IPC covers gamut of cases relating to “Offences affecting the Human Body”

C) Murder

A total of 2,004 cases of murder were registered during 2023, showing a decline of 1.3% over 2022 (2,031 cases). There is no change in crime rate (1.8%) in 2023. [Table – 2B.1]

‘Disputes’ (870 cases) was the motive of murder in highest number of cases followed by ‘Personal Vendetta or Enmity’ (353 cases) and ‘Illicit Relationship’ (109 cases). [Table – 2B.2]

D) Kidnapping & Abduction

A total of 15,039 cases of kidnapping & abduction were registered during 2023, showing an increase of 7.5% over 2022 (13,984 cases). [Table – 2D.1]

During 2023, a total of 15,181 kidnapped or abducted persons (4,914 male and 10,267 female) were recovered out of which 15,167 persons were recovered alive and 14 were found dead. [Table – 2D.4]

E) Offences against Public Tranquillity

A total of 2,965 cases of offences against public tranquillity were registered under various sections of IPC during 2023, out of which Rioting (1,219) accounting for 41.1% of total such cases. The cases of offences registered against public tranquillity have decreased by 14.2% in 2023 over 2022 (3,457 cases). [Table – 1B.4]

F) Crime against Women

A total of 51,393 cases of crime against women were registered during 2023, showing an increase of 5.4% over 2022 (48,755 cases). [Table – 3B.1]

Majority of cases under crime against women were registered under ‘Cruelty by Husband or his Relatives’ (15,813 Cases, 30.8%) followed by ‘Kidnaping & Abduction of Women’ (10,532 Cases, 20.5%), ‘Assault on Women with Intent to Outrage her Modesty’ (9,248 Cases, 18.0%), and ‘Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012’ (7,305 Cases, 14.2%). [Table – 3B.2]

G) Crime against Children

A total of 22,433 cases of crime against children were registered during 2023, showing an increase in registration by 9.2% over 2022 (20,550 cases). [Table – 4B.1]

In percentage terms, crime heads reporting majority of cases under ‘Crime Against Children’ were kidnapping & abduction (12,545 Cases, 55.9%) followed by Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012 (7,578 Cases, 33.8%). [Table – 4B.2]

H) Juveniles in Conflict with Law

A total of 5,480 cases have been registered against Juveniles during 2023, showing an increase of 2.4% over 2022 (5,352 cases). [Table – 5B.1]

A total of 7,521 juveniles were apprehended in 5,480 cases, out of which 6,882 juveniles were apprehended under IPC cases and 639 juveniles were apprehended under SLL cases during 2023. [Table – 5B.4]

Majority (79.8%) of juveniles in conflict with law apprehended under IPC & SLL crimes were in the age group of 16 to 18 years (6,002 out of 7,521) during 2023. [Table –5B.4]

I) Crime against Senior Citizens

A total of 4,412 cases of crime against senior citizens (aged above 60 years) were registered in 19 metropolitan cities during 2023 as compared to 3,996 cases during 2022, showing an increase in the registration by 10.4% during 2023 over 2022. [Table – 6B.1]

Crime head-wise cases revealed that FCF (Forgery, Cheating & Fraud) (28.4%, 1,251 cases) registered the highest number of cases of crimes against Senior Citizens followed by Theft with 23.7% (1,045 cases) during 2023. [Table – 6B.2]

J) Crime/Atrocities against Scheduled Castes (SCs)

A total of 2,520 cases were registered for committing crime against Scheduled Castes (SCs), showing an increase in registration by 7.4% over 2022 (2,347 cases). Crime head-wise cases revealed that Criminal Intimidation with 21.8% (549 cases) formed the highest number of cases registered under crimes/atrocities against Scheduled Castes (SCs) during 2023, it was followed by cases under Rape with 12.5% (314 cases) and Simple Hurt with 12.2% (307 cases). [Table – 7B.2]

K) Crime/Atrocities against Scheduled Tribes (STs)

A total of 349 cases were registered under crime against Scheduled Tribes (STs), showing an increase in registration by 6.1% over 2022 (329 cases). Crime head-wise cases revealed that rape (50 cases) formed the highest number of cases were registered under crimes/atrocities against Scheduled Tribes (STs) accounting for 14.3% during 2023, it was followed by simple hurt with 13.5% (47 cases) and Assault on women with intent to outrage her modesty with 9.5% (33 cases). [Table – 7D.2]

L) Economic Offences

A total of 41,220 cases registered under economic offences, showing an increase in registration by 1.1% over 2022 (40,760 cases). In 19 metropolitan cities, out of three specified category of economic offences viz. criminal breach of trust, counterfeiting and FCF (forgery, cheating & fraud), maximum cases were registered under FCF (36,426 cases) accounting for 88.4% during 2023. [Table – 8B.2]

M) Cyber Crimes

A total of 33,955 cases have been registered under Cyber Crimes, showing an Increase of 39.0% over 2022 (24,420 cases). Cyber crime rate has increased from 21.4 in 2022 to 29.8 in 2023. Crime head-wise cases revealed that Computer Related Offences (section 66 of IT Act) (20,468 cases) formed the highest number of Cyber Crimes accounting for 60.3% during 2023. [Table – 9B.2]

N) Offences against Property

As compared to 3,04,661 cases registered under offences against property in 2022, a total of 3,28,100 cases were registered, showing an increase of 7.7% during 2023. Maximum cases were reported under Theft (2,99,203 cases) accounting for 91.2% of total such cases.

Maximum theft cases were reported in Delhi (2,28,173 cases) followed by Bengaluru (10,438 cases), Jaipur (10,003 cases) and Mumbai (9,361 cases) accounting for 76.3%, 3.5%, 3.3% and 3.1% of total theft cases registered respectively. [Table – 1B.4]

O) Offences Relating to Documents & Property Marks

As compared to 36,154 cases in 2022, 36,547 cases were registered under offences relating to documents & property marks during 2023 comprising of Counterfeiting and FCF (forgery, cheating & fraud). FCF (36,426 cases) accounted for 99.7 % of total such cases. [Table – 1B.4]

P) Disposal of IPC Cases by Police & Court

S. No.	Crime Head under IPC	Total Cases for Investigation	Cases Charge-sheeted	Charge-sheeting Rate	Total Cases for Trial	Total Cases Convicted	Conviction Rate
1.	Murder	3,178	1,841	90.9	24,554	412	37.1
2.	Rape	4,905	3,090	87.3	26,567	495	24.2
3.	Rioting	3,432	1,092	90.4	31,104	240	30.5
4.	Kidnapping & Abduction	32,967	3,311	19.4	32,901	313	25.9

Note : Chargesheeting Rate = Cases Chargesheeted / Total Cases Disposed off by Police * 100

Conviction Rate = Cases Convicted / Cases in which Trials Completed * 100

Q) Disposal of SLL Cases by Police & Court

S. No.	Crime Head under SLL	Total Cases for Investigation	Cases Charge-sheeted	Charge-sheeting Rate	Total Cases for Trial	Total Cases Convicted	Conviction Rate
1.	The Excise Act	18,496	13,755	99.7	77,836	5,621	85.6
2.	Motor Vehicle Act	34,701	34,489	100.0	1,06,860	23,372	98.7
3.	Narcotics Drugs & Psychotropic Substances Act, 1985	43,590	26,863	99.9	1,02,758	13,852	90.6

Note : Chargesheeting Rate = Cases Chargesheeted / Total Cases Disposed off by Police * 100
Conviction Rate = Cases Convicted / Cases in which Trials Completed * 100

R) Arrests, Convictions & Acquittals

A total of 7,33,983 persons were arrested in 19 Metropolitan cities during 2023 as follows:

A total of 4,49,315 persons were arrested under 6,67,351 IPC crimes. A total of 4,90,297 persons were charge-sheeted, 1,46,022 persons were convicted, 95,153 persons were acquitted and 12,932 persons were discharged. [Table – 19B.6]

A total 2,84,668 persons were arrested under 2,76,940 SLL crimes. A total of 2,93,118 persons were charge-sheeted, 1,66,183 persons were convicted, 43,134 persons were acquitted and 5,162 persons were discharged. [Table – 19B.8]

Amongst these 19 Metropolitan Cities, cities reporting highest Charge-sheeting Rate under IPC Crimes are Kochi (97.2%), Kolkata (94.7%) and Pune (94.0%).

